

ETHNOGRAPHY

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OBSERVATIONAL METHODOLOGIES

DEFINITION

observation is a central methodology use to gather data about social practices, behavior & cultural norms within a natural settings.

TYPES

- **Participant observation**
- **Non participant observation**

PARTICIPANT OBSERVATION

The researcher becomes actively involved in the daily life of the study group while also observing their activities

TYPES

- **Complete participation**
- **participant as observer**
- **observer as participant**
- **complete observation**

NON PARTICIPANT OBSERVATION

The researcher observes without becoming involved in the group activities

2- OBSERVATION SETTING

- **NATURALISTIC OBSERVATION**
- **CONTROLLED OBSERVATION**

3-DATA COLLECTION TECHNIQUE

- **FIELD NOTES**

Field notes capture what the researcher sees, hears or experience

TYPES

1. DESCRIPTIVE NOTES
2. ANALYTICAL NOTES
3. PERSONAL NOTES

- **AUDIO VIDEO RECORDING**

It provides a more accurate & detailed account of the observed behaviors

4- ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

INFORMED CONSENT

- Participants should be fully informed about the research & provide their consent

CONFIDENTIALITY

- protecting the identities of participants

RESPECT & SENSITIVITY

- be mindful of cultural norms & privacy

5- DATA ANALYSIS

CODING & CATEGORIZATION

- systematically organizing & interpreting data

THEMATIC ANALYSIS

- data to identify recurring themes & patterns
Analyse

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

- Comparing observations across different context

6- REFLEXIVITY

Reflecting on how the researcher's background, perspective, and presence influence the research process and findings.

7- REPORTING FINDINGS

- DESCRIPTIVE ACCOUNTS
- ANALYTICAL INSIGHTS
- NARRATIVE CONSTRUCTION

INTERVIEWING METHODOLOGIES

Ethnographic research focuses on studying people and cultures in their natural environments through immersive observation and participation.

SUBDIVISIONS

- UNSTRUCTURED INTERVIEW
- SEMI STRUCTURED INTERVIEWS
- INFORMAL INTERVIEWS
- LIFE HISTORY INTERVIEWS
- GROUP INTERVIEWS
- NARRATIVE INTERVIEWS
- KEY INFORMANTS INTERVIEWS
- IN DEPTH INTERVIEWS

INTERVIEWING SETTINGS

The interviewing setting in ethnographic research is crucial as it influences the quality of the data collected and the comfort level of the participants.

1. Naturalistic Setting

Description: Conducting interviews in the participant's natural environment, such as their home, workplace, or community space.

2. Field Setting

Description: Interviews are conducted in the field, wherever the researcher is engaging in participant observation. This could be at community events, social gatherings, religious ceremonies, etc.

3. Private Setting

Description: This involves conducting interviews in a more private and controlled environment, such as a designated interview room, a quiet office, or a secluded area of a participant's home.

4. Public Setting

Interviews take place in public spaces such as cafes, parks, community centers, or public squares.

5. Virtual Setting

Interviews are conducted through digital means such as video conferencing (e.g., Zoom), phone calls, or online chat platforms.

6. Mobile Setting

Sometimes referred to as "walking interviews" or "go-along interviews," this setting involves conducting interviews while the researcher and participant are on the move,

7. Cultural/Community Setting

Conducting interviews within a specific cultural or community setting that is meaningful to the participants, such as a religious institution, cultural festival, or a community center.

8. Collaborative or Group Setting

Interviews are conducted in a group setting, such as a focus group or collective interview. This involves multiple participants interacting with each other as well as the interviewer.

ETHNOGRAPHIC COLLECTING AND READING CULTURAL ARTIFACTS

Ethnographic collecting is the practice of gathering objects, stories, images, and other cultural items from specific communities or cultures. These collections may include tools, clothing, art, religious or ritual objects, and even intangible elements like oral histories. The goal of this process is to preserve and study cultural heritage and diversity.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Historically, ethnographic collecting was often conducted by Western explorers, missionaries, and colonial administrators, who brought back objects from indigenous cultures to museums in Europe and North America.

ETHNOGRAPHIC ARTIFACTS

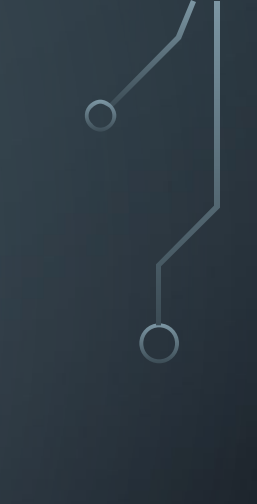
Ethnography is a branch of science that studies material remains revealed by human societies. It is also occasionally confused with the word folklore.

ETHNOGRAPHIC MUSEUM

We can define four studies about the role of art in contemporary museum studies, especially in ethnographic museums

TYPES OF CULTURAL ARTIFACTS IN ETHNOGRAPHY:

- **PHYSICAL OBJECTS**
- **TEXTUAL ARTIFACTS**
- **VISUAL & PERFORMING ARTS**
- **ORAL TRADITION**
- **DIGITAL ARTIFACTS**



COLLECTING CULTURAL ARTIFACTS

- **PARTICIPANT OBSERVATION**
 - **INTERVIEWS & CONVERSATION**
 - **ARCHIVAL RESEARCH**
 - **PHOTOGRAPHY & VIDEOGRAPHY**
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READING CULTURAL ARTIFACTS

Reading cultural artifacts in ethnography is a method used to gain deeper insights into a culture by examining the objects, symbols, and practices that are significant within that culture.

STEPS

- **OBSERVATION & DOCUMENTATION**
- **CONTEXTUAL ANALYSIS**
- **SYMBOLIC INTERPRETATION**
- **ENGAGEMENT WITH LOCAL NARRATIVE**
- **COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS**
- **INTERPRETATION WITHIN THEORETICAL FRAMEWORKS**
- **REFLEXIVITY & ETHICAL CONSIDERATION**

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